Web numbers

Spider Webs

Name _____ Date _____

Use these pretend notebook numbers about spider webs. The picture is not a ruler.

1. Little Wonderer counts 36 dew beads on one spiral loop, then 28 more on the next. How many beads is that together?

36 + 28 = _____ Show your thinking.

2. Big Wonderer spots 81 silk lines in a sketch, then erases 47 that were practice marks. How many lines remain?

81 − 47 = _____ Show your thinking.

3. The little one counts 45 dry radii marks and 37 spiral marks in a notebook. How many marks in all?

45 + 37 = _____ Show your thinking.

Web numbers

Spider Webs

Name _____ Date _____

Use these pretend notebook numbers about spider webs. The picture is not a ruler.

4. A morning count shows 70 dew beads. Later 26 have dried. How many beads are left to see?

70 − 26 = _____

Show your thinking.

5. Big Wonderer times 58 soft table taps, then 19 harder taps. How many taps in the vibration try?

58 + 19 = _____

Show your thinking.

6. The big one sketches 93 spiral loops across pages, then crosses out 58 extras. How many loops stay?

93 − 58 = _____

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

Spider Webs

A web in the dew

Cool air leaves dew on silk. The beads catch light, so a quiet web suddenly shows.

Hub, radii, spiral

Hub in the center. Radii like spokes. Spiral may hold glue. Many spiders walk the dry lines.

Silk that catches

Dragline silk is strong. Capture silk may hold glue beads, or it may be woolly cribellate silk that snags without glue.

Feeling a tug

Silk carries tiny vibrations. Legs on dry radii feel a tug that may mean prey.

Look, don't touch

A web is a home and a trap. Watch from a step back. Sketch, don't touch.

Beads of light

Dew is water from cool air. It catches light so we can see the web's pattern.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

Explain a web clue in your words

Spider Webs · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one picture. Say your idea first, then draw or write it.



Hub, radii, spiral



Two kinds of catch silk



Beads of morning light

Draw an orb web. Mark the hub, one radius, and one spiral loop.

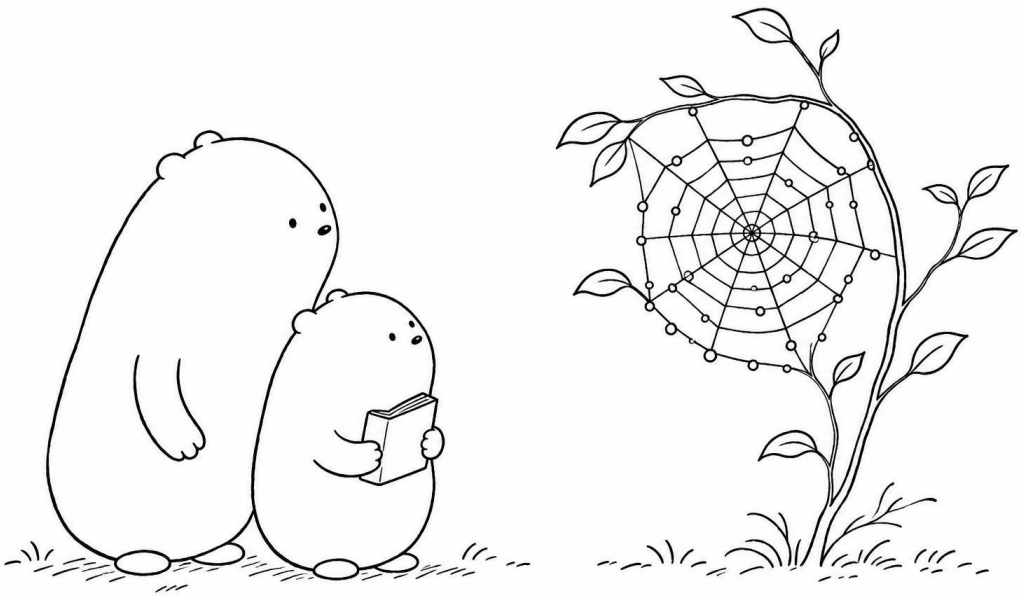
hub · radii · spiral · silk · because · maybe

The dry lines are often the radii because … what job do the spokes do?

Some silk can catch without glue because … what is woolly cribellate silk like?

Dew makes a web easier to see because … what do the beads do to light?

Does your sentence tell what you noticed and use because or maybe to explain?



Please Don't Pat the Lace

Little Wonderer spotted a shine in the hedge,
a wheel made of whispers along the leaf edge.
"It's lace!" cried the little one. "May I tap it, just once?"
Big Wonderer answered, "Let's look — not a touch."

They counted the spokes that ran dry from the hub,
then the spiral that glittered with one tiny bead-dub.
"Some silk may be sticky; some silk may be strong,"
said the big one. "The builder feels tugs all day long."

A breeze made a shiver that raced down a line.
The little one whispered, "That signal's a sign!"
They sketched from a step back, both quiet and still,
while dew beads lit pathways along the green hill.

So if you find lace on a bush in the sun,
remember the worker whose weaving is done.
Look close with your eyes, keep your fingers in place —
and thank the small spinner. Please don't pat the lace.

Spider Webs

01 Which lines are sticky on an orb web?



Strong dry spokes. A spiral that may hold glue.

Look closer. Find the center hub, the straight lines that go out like spokes, and the spiral that winds around them.

A little explanation. On many orb webs, the spokes (radii) and the small hub are dry and strong. The outer spiral often holds tiny glue beads. Spiders walk the dry lines and feel prey on the sticky spiral. Not every web is an orb, and not every spiral is sticky the same way.

Try this. From a few steps away, sketch a web you can see. Mark the hub, three spokes, and one loop of the spiral. Do not touch the silk.

02 How can silk catch without glue?



Glue beads, or woolly silk that snags.

Look closer. Find the two silk samples: one with shiny droplets, and one that looks soft and woolly.

A little explanation. Some spiders make capture silk with glue droplets (ecribellate silk). Others comb out a dry, woolly silk with a special plate called a cribellum (cribellate silk). The woolly silk snags legs and wings without sticky glue. Scientists still study exactly how each kind works best.

Try this. On your sketch, label one spiral loop 'maybe glue' and write one question you still have about silk.

03 How does a spider feel a tiny tug?



Vibrations travel along the silk.

Look closer. Find the spider resting near the hub, with one or two legs on the silk.

A little explanation. Silk carries vibrations. Many spiders keep legs on the radii so a buzz or tug can travel to them. Tiny sensors in the legs help them tell a breeze from a struggling insect. They usually do not need sticky feet on every line because they know the dry paths.

Try this. Tap a table lightly with a pencil, then harder. Tell which tap felt bigger through your hand. That is only a toy model of vibration, not a real web.

04 Why does dew make a web easy to see?



Dew catches light so we can see the pattern.

Look closer. Find the morning web with water beads shining on the spiral.

A little explanation. Cool mornings leave tiny water drops on silk. The drops catch light, so the web that was nearly invisible overnight suddenly shows its pattern. As the air warms, many drops shrink or fall. Dew helps us look; it is not glue from the spider.

Try this. On a cool morning, look for a web on a fence or bush. Count how many spiral loops you can see before the dew fades. Stay back and do not touch.